



EXTERNAL AFFAIRS
(clockwise from far left) A 120 sq ft compact balcony in Baner, Pune; textures add drama in this 250 sq ft outdoor space in NIBM, Pune; colours pop in this terrace spanning 1,100 sq ft in Kothrud, Pune

Photographs by EKANSH CHAURASIA

In an age defined by urgency, the luxury of pause is no longer optional—it's essential. While we often chase calm in distant destinations, serenity can begin much closer to home. Imagine your own private retreat, cradled in the clouds, where time slows down and the city hum fades. Your balcony or terrace isn't just an architectural afterthought—it's your most intimate space in the sky.

A well-conceived balcony balances openness with seclusion, sky views with grounded comfort. Whether you're basking in the golden morning light over a quiet cup of tea or gathering friends for an al fresco sundowner, this small pocket of space can become a deeply transformative everyday experience.

Design with Purpose Intentionality is the cornerstone of an elevated balcony. It's not just about making it look good—it's about making it feel like you.

Compact Seating For modest spaces, built-in benches, stackable chairs, or earthy floor seating like *gaddas* and poufs create comfort without crowding. Think cosy nooks with fluid movement.

Vertical Greenery When floor space is scarce, look skyward. Creeping vines, herb ladders and modular planters sculpt blank walls into verdant, living art—low-maintenance yet immensely soothing.

Layered Lighting As day slips into dusk, lighting sets the mood. Lanterns, fairy lights and warm LED accents soften the space, creating a cocoon of calm perfect for evening reflection.

Textural Warmth Rugs, cane swings, oversized cushions and playful textiles add soul to the structure—each layer inviting you to linger a little longer.

Meaningful Details Curate your story with traditional wall plates, terracotta sculptures or handcrafted mirrors. These are more than objects; they are extensions of you.

Don't think of this as just outdoor decor, it's about a shift in mindset, a cool refuge in monsoons. After all, with just a few blooms such as hibiscus or bougainvillea, the space can brim with life and rhythm.